

PrEP

all about LENACAPAVIR

Lenacapavir = LEN

LEN is a 6-monthly HIV prevention option, it is for people who test negative for HIV

LEN is **more than 96% effective** in preventing HIV if it is used as prescribed!

**PrEP ♥ IS
CHOICE**
#ICHOOSEME

HIV prevention choices

LEN is an additional HIV prevention option.

There are many ways to prevent HIV, we call this combination prevention. Speak to your healthcare provider to find out what is available and choose according to your needs.

- ♥ Condoms
- ♥ HIV testing
- ♥ PrEP (LEN and oral PrEP)
- ♥ PEP
- ♥ STI management
- ♥ Male medical circumcision
- ♥ ART for people living with HIV

What is the difference between PrEP, PEP, and ART?

All three use antiretrovirals in different combinations for the following purposes:

- ♥ **PrEP** is when ARVs are taken before exposure to HIV, to prevent getting HIV
- ♥ **PEP** is when ARVs are taken after exposure to HIV, to prevent HIV (within 72 hours and taken for 28 days only)
- ♥ **ART** is when ARVs are used to treat a person living with HIV, and is taken lifelong

More about the LEN injection:

- ♥ LEN is six-monthly injections given to prevent HIV.
- ♥ LEN is safe to use!
- ♥ LEN contains an antiretroviral ingredient called **lenacapavir** which is injected on the stomach area or thighs.



WHO CAN USE LEN?

Any person who has an HIV-negative test result and weighs 35kg or more.



health

Department:
Health
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

Starting LEN...

When you start using LEN for the first time, you will

Receive 2 injections and 2 pills



IMPORTANT:

The two tablets that you take on day 1 and day 2, must be taken 24 hours apart, not sooner and not later!

Set a reminder!

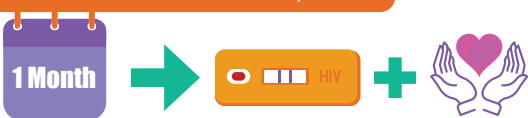
Receive 2 pills to take home, to be taken the next day



How soon does it start working?

Day 3 LEN starts working on **DAY 3** if you received the injection and taken 2 tablets on day 1, and 2 tablets on day 2.

Return to the clinic after 1 month for an HIV test and check-up



Return to the clinic every six months for 2 injections



Set a reminder to return to the clinic every 6 months!

Why choose LEN?

- ♥ It can be kept private
- ♥ It is safe
- ♥ It is very effective in preventing HIV
- ♥ There is no need to remember to use it every day

ANY SIDE EFFECTS?

Most people experience injection site reactions (redness, pain, and/or swelling). A small number of people may experience nausea or feeling sick. If you experience any of these reactions, the staff at the clinic will assist you.

IMPORTANT: It is normal to feel a small lump under the skin where the injection was given - this is normal and you don't have to be concerned about this.

HOW DOES LEN PREVENT HIV?

Lenacapavir is slowly released into the bloodstream where it prevents HIV from multiplying.

LEN prevents HIV. It does not prevent pregnancy or STIs.

Condoms and contraception can be used together with LEN if you want to prevent STIs and getting pregnant.

LEN DURING PREGNANCY AND BREASTFEEDING

- ♥ Women are more likely to get HIV when they are pregnant or during the time after birth.
- ♥ LEN can be used during pregnancy and breastfeeding. It protects both mother and baby from getting HIV.
- ♥ Speak to a healthcare provider about the benefits of using LEN during pregnancy and breastfeeding.

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN I STOP USING LEN?

At 28 weeks after your last injection, LEN is no longer preventing HIV. If you are likely to still be exposed to HIV, you need to use other HIV prevention methods, for example, oral PrEP and/or condoms. Talk to your healthcare provider who will provide more information about stopping LEN.

Ask PrEP anything on
078 168 0192



PrEP IS CHOICE
#ICHOOSEME